75 I can use time words and phrases

A Past, present and future

Look at the **diary** and read the sentences below. It's midday on Thursday, 11 April.

APRIL					
Mon	8	Jon and Trish 7.30	Mon	15	London
Tues	9	pay phone bill	Tues	16	dinner with Scott 8.00
Wed	10	lunch with Liz 1.00 meet Brian 7.45	Wed	17	
Thur	(11)	cinema 7.15	Thur	18	Dr Holton 10.45
Fri	12	meeting 9.00 – 12.00 Wheeler's bar 7.30	Fri	19	theatre 8.00
Sat	13	stay at Gary's	Sat	20	Pete's birthday
Sun	14		Sun	21	Mum and Dad for lunch

I was in Moscow **last week.**
I saw Jon and Trish three days **ago.**
I had lunch with Liz **yesterday.**
I went out with Brian **last night.**
I'm going to the cinema **this evening.**

I've got a meeting **tomorrow morning.**
I'm going to stay at Gary's **this weekend.**
Then I'm in London for three days **next week.**
I have a doctor's **appointment next Thursday.**
I'm seeing my parents **in** ten days' **time.**

1 **True or false? Write *T* or *F*.**

▶ I was in Moscow last week. T

1 I got back from Moscow four days ago. _____
2 I saw Jon and Trish this week. _____
3 I paid the phone bill three days ago. _____
4 I met Brian yesterday. _____
5 I was in London last week. _____
6 I'm going to the cinema this afternoon. _____
7 I'm going out tomorrow evening. _____
8 I'm seeing Scott in four days' time. _____
9 I'm seeing the doctor in a week's time. _____
10 I'm going to the theatre next Friday. _____

Glossary

last week = April 1 – 7 NOT ~~the last week~~
this week = April 8 – 14
next week = April 15 – 21 NOT ~~the next week~~
last night OR **yesterday evening**
NOT ~~yesterday night/last evening~~
appointment a meeting at a fixed time, often with one person, usually for work or with a doctor, dentist, etc.

2 **Complete the sentences.**

▶ We saw them yesterday evening.
1 She saw Paul about three days _____.
2 I wrote Pete's birthday in my _____.
3 She rang me at 10 o'clock last _____.
4 He wants to come in a week's _____.
5 She can't come. She's got a dentist's _____.
6 I'm going to Italy _____ week.

3 **Look at the diary again. It is now Wednesday, 17 April. Write three more things about last week and three things about this week.**

▶ I had lunch with Liz a week ago.
1 _____ on Thursday evening.
2 _____ five days ago.
3 _____ last weekend.
4 _____ tomorrow morning.
5 _____ in three days' time.
6 _____ this weekend.

B Words and phrases often confused

before/after	 10.00 11.00 12.00 Lunch 2.00 3.00 4.00 *We did some shopping **before** lunch. We went for a coffee **after** lunch.*
at the moment/ in a minute	*I'm very busy **at the moment.*** = I'm very busy now. NOT ~~in this moment~~ *I'll speak to you **in a minute.*** = I'll speak to you one or two minutes from now.
soon/later	*I'm going home **soon.*** = I'm going home in a short time from now. *Can I talk to you **later**?* = Can I talk to you in the future but not now?
until	*We worked **until** ten o'clock.* = We stopped work at 10.00. NOT ~~by 10.00~~ *I want to stay here **until** July.* = I don't want to go before July.
for/since	I moved to this house. Sarah was born. → Sarah is now five years old. *I've lived here **since** Sarah was born.* *I've lived here **for** five years.*

4 **Circle the correct answer.**

▶ Dinner will be ready at/in a minute.

1 I had a shower before/after I went to bed.
2 We went home before/after work and watched TV.
3 I usually work until/for one o'clock, and then have a sandwich.
4 She's in the library at/in the moment.
5 I haven't seen her for/since last week.
6 I'm very busy this morning. Can I phone you later/soon?
7 She has worked here for/since seven years.
8 The taxi will be here later/soon. Are you ready?

spotlight ***for* and *since***

We use **for** with a period of time (***for*** *two weeks, six months,* etc.), and **since** with a point in time (***since*** *2003, last year, I came to England,* etc.). We often use these words with the present perfect.
*I've been at university **for a year**.*
*I've known Joe **since** 2002.*

5 **Complete the sentences. Use *soon, later, before, at, in, until, for* or *since*.**

▶ I had a rest *after* lunch.

1 She waited _____ 7.00, then went home.
2 He's been here _____ three weeks.
3 I'm getting tired. Can we go home _____ ?
4 Can you help me? ~ Yes, I'll be with you _____ a minute.
5 What are you doing _____ the moment?
6 We haven't seen them _____ last summer.
7 I wrote the email _____ I went out.
8 I'm busy tomorrow. Can we go out _____ this week?

6 **Translate the words in bold in this unit into your own language.**